The Journal of Open Source Software

ASSUME - Agent-based Simulation for Studying and Understanding Market Evolution

Florian Maurer [1*¶], **Nick Harder** [2*], **Kim K. Miskiw** [3*], **and Manish Khanra** [4*]

1 University of Applied Sciences Aachen, Germany **2** Institute for Sustainable Systems Engineering, University of Freiburg, Freiburg, Germany **3** Institute of Information Systems and Marketing, Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, Karlsruhe, Germany **4** Fraunhofer Institute for Systems and Innovation Research, Karlsruhe, Germany ¶ Corresponding author * These authors contributed equally.

DOI: 10.xxxxxx/draft

Software

- Review
- Repository
- Archive

Editor:

Submitted: 15 November 2024
Published: unpublished

License
Authors of papers retain copyright and release the work under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (CC BY 4.0).

DRAFT

Summary

ASSUME is an open-source toolbox for agent-based simulations of various energy markets, with a primary focus on European electricity markets. Developed as an open-source model, its objectives are to ensure usability and customizability for a wide range of users and use cases in the energy system modeling community.

A unique feature of the ASSUME toolbox is its integration of **Deep Reinforcement Learning** methods into the behavioral strategies of market agents. The model offers various predefined agent representations for both the demand and generation sides, which can be used as plug-and-play modules, simplifying the usage of reinforcement learning strategies. This setup enables research of new market designs and evolving dynamics in energy markets.

Statement of need

Various open-source agent-based models have been developed for studying energy markets, such as PowerACE (Bublitz et al., 2014) and AMIRIS (Schimeczek et al., 2023). Yet, the possible integration of reinforcement learning methods into the behavioral strategies of market agents is currently unique to ASSUME and is build upon prior research on multi-agent reinforcement learning (Harder et al., 2023). Simulations which solely rely on rule-based bidding strategy representation, limit the ability to represent future markets or alternative markets designs, as in reality bidding agents would adapt to the new market design. Most notably, ASSUME enables the highest number of simultanelously learning market agents in literature (Miskiw & Staudt, 2024). This feature allows for the exploration of new market designs and emergent dynamics in energy markets using a common open-source simulation framework. Further unique features of ASSUME are the extensive market abstraction which allows to define complex multi-market scenarios as shown in (Maurer et al., 2023). Even redispatch markets and nodal markets are supported, making it possible to represent network constraints and market coupling. ASSUME is designed to provide results which are easily comparable and interactable. This is set in contrast to other agent-based simulation frameworks, which are often designed to be used for a specific use case. Instead, various moving parts can be configured, such as the market abstraction, the agent properties and bidding strategies, or the reinforcement learning methods.

Architecture

ASSUME builds on the open-source agent-based simulation library mango-agents to model the simulation world and to give users continuous feedback during the simulation runs. Interaction with the results of the simulation is possible through the preconfigured provided Grafana dashboards, which do have direct access to the simulation database. Additionally, writing the output to CSV files is supported for scenarios in which a database is not available or needed.

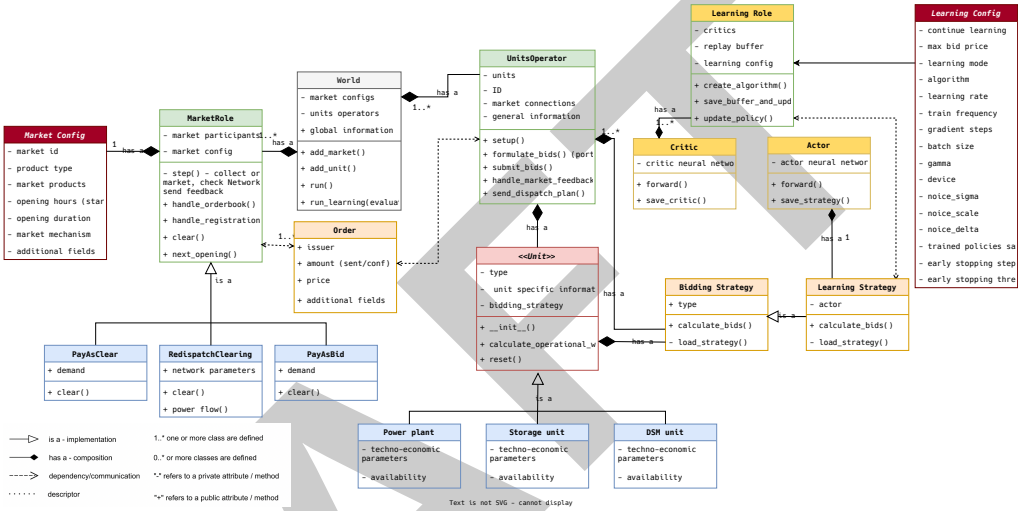

Figure 1: Componental overview of the ASSUME simulation architecture

New scenarios can be created by providing CSV files, accessing simulation data from a database or by using the object-oriented API. The object-oriented API makes it possible to integrate new classes, maket mechanisms and bidding strategies as well.

Less technical users can adjust the examples from the yaml config and csv inputs directly, while new bidding strategies and methods can be implemented using the provided base classes. This is possible through the decoupled architecture which separates the declaration of simulation behavior from the input data, while allowing to define either externally without changes to the core. The overview of available classes and the interaction with the world is shown in Figure 1. Extensive documentation about these features is available at https://assume.readthedocs.io/en/latest/. This also includes a variety of notebooks which clarify the usage through examples.

Publications

ASSUME has been used to investigate the usage of complex order types like block bids in wholesale markets (Adams et al., 2024) as well as for the integration of demand-side flexibility and redispatch markets in (Khanra et al., 2024). Studies of applicability of reinforcement learning methods in energy markets were tackled in (Harder et al., 2024), while an analysis of explainable AI methods was applied to ASSUME in (Miskiw & Staudt, 2024). For better interoperability with other energy system model data, adapters to interact from ASSUME with PyPSA and AMIRIS are available and make a comparison to other renomated market simulation tools possible (Maurer et al., 2024).

DRAFT

Acknowledgements

This work was conducted as part of the project "ASSUME: Agent-Based Electricity Markets Simulation Toolbox," funded by the German Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy under grant number BMWK 03EI1052A. We express our gratitude to all contributors to ASSUME.

References

Adams, J., Harder, N., & Weidlich, A. (2024). Do Block Orders Matter? Impact of Regular Block and Linked Orders on Electricity Market Simulation Outcomes. *2024 20th International Conference on the European Energy Market (EEM)*, 1–7. https://doi.org/10.1109/EEM60825.2024.10608956

Bublitz, A., Ringler, P., Genoese, M., & Fichtner, W. (2014). Agent-based Simulation of the German and French Wholesale Electricity Markets. *Proceedings of the 6th International Conference on Agents and Artificial Intelligence - Volume 2*, 40–49. https://doi.org/10.5220/0004760000400049

Harder, N., Mitridati, L., Pourahmadi, F., Weidlich, A., & Kazempour, J. (2024). How Satisfactory Can Deep Reinforcement Learning Methods Simulate Electricity Market Dynamics? Bechmarking via Bi-level Optimization. *Energy Informatics Review*.

Harder, N., Qussous, R., & Weidlich, A. (2023). Fit for purpose: Modeling wholesale electricity markets realistically with multi-agent deep reinforcement learning. *Energy and AI*, *14*, 100295. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.egyai.2023.100295

Khanra, M., Klobasa, M., Patil, P., & Scholz, D. (2024). Economic Evaluation of Electricity and Hydrogen-Based Steel Production Pathways: Leveraging Market Dynamics and Grid Congestion Mitigation through Demand Side Flexibility. *2024 20th International Conference on the European Energy Market (EEM)*, 1–6. https://doi.org/10.1109/EEM60825.2024.10608890

Maurer, F., Miskiw, K. K., Acosta, R. R., Harder, N., Sander, V., & Lehnhoff, S. (2023). Market Abstraction of Energy Markets and Policies - Application in an Agent-Based Modeling Toolbox. In B. N. Jørgensen, L. C. P. Da Silva, & Z. Ma (Eds.), *Energy Informatics* (Vol. 14468, pp. 139–157). Springer Nature Switzerland. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-48652-4_10

Maurer, F., Nitsch, F., Kochems, J., Schimeczek, C., Sander, V., & Lehnhoff, S. (2024). Know Your Tools - A Comparison of Two Open Agent-Based Energy Market Models. *2024 20th International Conference on the European Energy Market (EEM)*, 1–8. https://doi.org/10.1109/EEM60825.2024.10609021

Miskiw, K. K., & Staudt, P. (2024). Explainable Deep Reinforcement Learning for Multi-Agent Electricity Market Simulations. *2024 20th International Conference on the European Energy Market (EEM)*, 1–9. https://doi.org/10.1109/EEM60825.2024.10608907

Schimeczek, C., Nienhaus, K., Frey, U., Sperber, E., Sarfarazi, S., Nitsch, F., Kochems, J., & Ghazi, A. A. E. (2023). AMIRIS: Agent-based Market model for the Investigationof Renewable and Integrated energy Systems. *Journal of Open Source Software*, *8*(84). https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.05041

DRAFT